



THE VAULT

The Interview Guide

The questions you will be asked, and the spirit in which to meet them

THE PRIVATE CONCIERGE ACADEMY

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What is actually being tested

You will be asked ordinary questions. Almost none of them are about the answer. A family, or the consultant who protects them, is testing three things, and only three: **can you be trusted with what you will inevitably come to know**, **will you remain calm when the day collapses**, and **will you be pleasant to have in the house for years**.

Competence is assumed by the time you are in the room. If they doubted it, you would not be there. So do not spend the hour proving it. Spend the hour being the person they are hoping to find.

The posture

Arrive early and wait outside. Dress a level below the family, never above. Speak slightly less than you wish to. Do not fill silences: in this world, the person who is comfortable in a silence is the person in control of it. And never, at any point, be interesting at the expense of being safe.

The questions, and what they are really asking

“Tell me about yourself.”

They are testing restraint. Ninety seconds, no more: where you have served, what you were trusted with, and why this role. Then stop. The candidate who speaks for six minutes has already answered a different question, and badly.

“Why do you want to work for a private family?”

They are listening for the word “I”. The wrong answer is about your journey, your growth, your dream. The right answer is about them: the pleasure of a life that runs without friction, the craft of making that true.

“Tell me about a difficult client or principal.”

This is the discretion test, and it is the one most candidates fail. They are not asking for the story. They are watching to see whether you will tell it. Give the shape, never the detail, and never the person: “There was a situation that required a great deal of care. It was handled, and it stays with me.”

“What would you do if you saw something you were not meant to see?”

The answer is short. Nothing. You would see nothing, say nothing, and it would leave no trace in you. If you are tempted to add a nuance here, do not.

“How do you handle a change of plan at eleven at night?”

They are asking whether the disruption reaches your face. Describe your method calmly: the alternatives you keep ready, the suppliers who answer, the way you inform without alarming. Method reassures. Enthusiasm does not.

“What are your weaknesses?”

Answer honestly and briefly, with something real and unthreatening, and say what you do about it. A polished non-answer here is more damaging than the weakness itself.

“What are your salary expectations?”

Give a range, calmly, and only if asked. Then let it sit. Do not justify it, do not soften it, do not immediately offer flexibility. The person who apologises for their number invites it to be lowered.

The questions you should ask

You will be invited to ask. What you ask is itself an answer.

- “How is the household organised today, and who would I be working alongside?”, you are showing that you think in teams, and that you will not tread on a colleague’s station.
- “What would make you say, in six months, that this was the right decision?”, the most valuable question you can ask anyone.
- “How does the family prefer to be communicated with, and how often?”, it demonstrates that you understand the role is theirs, not yours.
- “Is there anything in the way the house runs that you would like to see change?”, this is where they tell you the truth about the job.

Never ask, at a first meeting: holidays, time off, whether the role can be done remotely, or anything that begins with “would I have to...”.

The background check

Expect it, and never be surprised by it. Identity, history, references, sometimes finances and social media. It is not suspicion, it is standard, and it is the price of being admitted anywhere near a family of this kind. Prepare your history so that it is coherent, verifiable and calmly explained, including any gap. A gap that is explained without discomfort is not a problem. A gap that is defended becomes one.

The last five minutes

Thank them once, simply. Do not oversell at the door, do not send a long letter that evening. A short, warm note the next morning, three lines, no more, is the correct gesture, and it is remembered precisely because it asks for nothing.